

ML Howell

Senior Product Designer • San Francisco, CA

Product designer who ships code, with 8 years across product and brand.

CONTACT

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EXPERIENCE

Founding Product Designer • Guac (YC 2023)

Jun 2024 – Mar 2026

- Sole designer alongside 7 engineers building AI-powered enterprise tools to replace grocers' legacy systems. Shipped 5 products to 3 multi-store chains (21 stores live, 60-store chain onboarding). Helped grow the company from initial pilot to 7-figure ARR.
- Led design of iOS, Android, and web products spanning store ordering, forecasting and product recommendations, ingredient breakdowns, and recipe management.
- Drove features from concept and wireframes to prototyping and final spec, working directly in the codebase to explore ideas and validate workflows.
- Shipped marketing website PRs directly to codebase.
- Designed AI forecasting to build user trust, letting store teams drill into the data. Designed dashboard interfaces to make data intuitive and store operations transparent.
- Led brand design of conference booths, sales decks, printed materials, and website.

Product Designer • Afresh

Nov 2022 – May 2024

- Led design of user onboarding, in-store training assets, and training platform.
- Owned the design system through a full redesign, raising craft, improving consistency of visual language, and accelerating team speed across 9 designers.
- Partnered with PMs and engineers across multiple product squads to conduct user research. Traveled to a key LA customer post-launch to diagnose issues.

Senior Brand Designer • Afresh

Nov 2021 – Nov 2022

- Led a full brand refresh as the company scaled to a \$115M Series B, partnering with agency and 3D artists. Extended the work across marketing, sales, social, and events.
- Led brand design of conference booths, video, sales decks, reports, and microsites.

Brand Designer • theSkimm

Feb 2019 – Nov 2021

- Designed interactive websites, branded materials, and graphics for women-focused media startup, including launch of its health & wellness content pillar.
- Redesigned brand illustrations during a refresh, developing templates and guidelines.

PROJECTS

Doodles • doodle.mary-louise.com

- AI image generation microsite built on Reveal's API. 80+ users, 11k social impressions.

Street Cleaning Parking • streetcleaningparking.com

- Consumer iOS app with 150 paid users, featured in [ABC News](#) and [SF Standard](#).

TOOLS & SKILLS

Tooling: Figma, Claude Code, HTML/CSS, Adobe Creative Suite

Skills: Interaction Design, Rapid Prototyping, Design Systems, User Research, Brand Design, Typography, Illustration

EDUCATION

MA in Graphic Design • Maryland Institute College of Art, Baltimore, Maryland

BA in English Literature • University of Edinburgh, Edinburgh, Scotland